

GED Social Studies Practice Test 17

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC17-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state creates a “pay-as-you-go” rule for certain public building repairs. Under the rule, lawmakers must set aside money each year for roof replacements, heating systems, and safety upgrades instead of waiting until buildings deteriorate and then borrowing a large amount. Supporters argue that routine funding can reduce emergency costs and make future budgets more predictable.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this rule?

- A) Encouraging planned maintenance through regular budget decisions
- B) Giving private contractors power to pass state laws
- C) Allowing courts to manage all public buildings
- D) Preventing lawmakers from funding public facilities

GED-SOC17-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city compares two waste collection proposals.

Proposal: A, B

Monthly household fee: \$18, \$22

Recycling pickup: Every 2 weeks, Weekly

Estimated landfill reduction: 8%, 18%

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Proposal B costs more per household but is expected to reduce landfill use more.
- B) Proposal A has the higher household fee and higher landfill reduction.
- C) Both proposals have the same recycling schedule.
- D) Proposal B costs less and reduces landfill use less.

GED-SOC17-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1880s and 1890s, some Southern states rewrote their constitutions to add poll taxes, literacy tests, and other voting rules. Supporters claimed these rules improved elections. Critics argued that

the measures were designed to reduce Black political participation and weaken Reconstruction-era gains.

Which historical issue is most clearly reflected in the source?

- A) The restriction of voting rights after Reconstruction
- B) The debate over whether to purchase western land
- C) The creation of the first federal income tax
- D) The spread of television during the Cold War

GED-SOC17-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A described map shows a coastal country with three economic zones. The northern coast has cold waters and fishing ports. The central coast has beaches and hotels. The southern coast has mangrove forests and shrimp farms. Inland mountains have few roads and scattered villages.

Which statement best explains the pattern shown on the described map?

- A) Coastal conditions and resources support different economic activities.
- B) All coastal regions must have the same economy.
- C) Mangrove forests prevent all economic activity.
- D) Inland mountains always have more roads than coastal areas.

GED-SOC17-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state creates a formula for distributing courthouse renovation funds. The formula considers building age, security needs, disability access, and the number of cases handled each year. Some rural counties argue that building age should count more, while larger counties argue that case volume should count more.

Which TWO statements best explain the civic issue in this situation?

- A) Funding formulas can balance physical condition with public service demand.
- B) Different communities may define public need in different ways.
- C) Courthouse funding is unrelated to access to justice.
- D) Rural counties may ignore state funding rules.
- E) Case volume and building age are always the same measure.

GED-SOC17-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A federal official argues that national standards are needed for drone deliveries because drones may cross city and state boundaries. The official says one rule for altitude, registration, and safety equipment would make the system easier to enforce.

Source B:

A city official argues that local governments should be able to add rules for drones near schools, hospitals, and crowded downtown streets. The official says local conditions affect safety risks and should not be controlled only by a national rule.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether drone delivery rules should be nationally uniform or allow local safety limits
- B) Whether drones should be used to appoint judges
- C) Whether cities may create their own national currency
- D) Whether hospitals should control interstate commerce

GED-SOC17-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During the 1930s, some labor organizers used radio speeches, union newspapers, and public rallies to explain workers' demands. They argued that collective bargaining could improve wages and working conditions. Business leaders often warned that unions could raise costs and disrupt production.

Which broader historical pattern is shown by the source?

- A) Workers and employers debated the role of unions in industrial life.
- B) Unions avoided all public communication during the 1930s.
- C) Business leaders always supported collective bargaining.
- D) Industrial workers had no connection to public debate.

GED-SOC17-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

When a public agency may act only within powers given by law, it is limited by [D1]. If it acts beyond those powers, a court may find the action [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) statutory authority | naturalization | popular vote

D2) unauthorized | ratified | inherited

GED-SOC17-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A borrower takes a \$7,500 loan at a simple annual interest rate of 6%. How many dollars of interest will the borrower owe after one year?

Type your answer as a dollar amount without the dollar sign.

GED-SOC17-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A region grows vegetables in greenhouses during the winter. The greenhouses depend on natural gas for heat and trucks for delivery to urban markets. When fuel prices rise, some growers switch to better insulation, shorter delivery routes, and contracts with nearby grocery stores.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Energy and transportation costs can influence agricultural business decisions.
- B) Greenhouse farming is never affected by fuel prices.
- C) Urban markets are unrelated to farm production.
- D) Shorter delivery routes always increase fuel use.

GED-SOC17-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state requires cities to test drinking water for certain chemicals and publish results in a standard format. Cities may choose which certified laboratory to use, but they must test on the schedule set by state law.

Which statement best explains this state-local relationship?

- A) The state sets a required standard while cities choose an approved method for carrying it out.
- B) Cities may ignore state water-testing requirements.
- C) Certified laboratories write state constitutions.
- D) Drinking water testing is controlled only by private homeowners.

GED-SOC17-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows union membership in two industries.

Year: 1940, 1960, 1980

Steelworkers: 410,000, 620,000, 390,000

Hospital workers: 40,000, 180,000, 520,000

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Hospital worker union membership increased while steelworker membership rose and then

declined.

- B) Steelworker membership increased every year listed.
- C) Hospital worker membership decreased from 1940 to 1980.
- D) Both industries had the same membership in 1980.

GED-SOC17-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution allows the legislature to create an independent revenue-estimating conference. The conference includes representatives from the executive budget office, the legislature, and a nonpartisan research office. Its estimate is used as the official revenue forecast when lawmakers write the budget.

Which statement best describes the purpose of this arrangement?

- A) It creates a shared estimate to guide budget decisions.
- B) It allows private banks to pass tax laws.
- C) It prevents lawmakers from discussing revenue.
- D) It gives courts authority to spend budget funds.

GED-SOC17-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A country requires imported clothing to meet certain labor and safety certification rules. Supporters say the rules discourage unsafe production and help consumers make ethical choices. Importers argue that certification raises costs and may reduce the variety of goods available.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Trade rules can pursue social goals while increasing costs for some businesses.
- B) Certification rules always lower business costs.
- C) Importers are never affected by product standards.
- D) Consumer choices are unrelated to trade policy.

GED-SOC17-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires that public scholarships be awarded using published eligibility standards, such as income, residency, academic progress, or field of study. Officials may not award scholarships based on personal connections or political support.

Which civic principle is most directly reflected?

- A) Public benefits should be distributed through transparent and neutral criteria.
- B) Public scholarships should be awarded through personal favoritism.
- C) Political support should determine educational aid.
- D) Eligibility standards are unnecessary for public funds.

GED-SOC17-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

During the 1950s and 1960s, some Puerto Rican communities in U.S. cities created neighborhood organizations, bilingual newspapers, cultural centers, and legal-aid groups. These institutions helped residents respond to housing discrimination, language barriers, school issues, and employment challenges.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Community institutions helped migrants address local social and economic problems.
- B) Cultural and language resources were part of urban community-building.
- C) Puerto Rican communities avoided creating public organizations.
- D) Housing and school issues had no connection to migration.
- E) Legal-aid groups prevented residents from seeking rights.

GED-SOC17-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country compares energy use and population by region.

Region: Coastal, Interior, Highland

Share of population: 45%, 35%, 20%

Share of energy use: 55%, 25%, 20%

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) The Coastal region uses a larger share of energy than its share of population.
- B) The Interior region uses the largest share of energy.
- C) The Highland region has the smallest share of population and the largest share of energy use.
- D) All three regions use energy in the same proportion as population.

GED-SOC17-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A court reviews a state law that gives extra transportation aid to counties with heavy winter

snowfall. The state argues that snow removal creates costs that warmer counties do not face. Some warmer counties argue that they also have road maintenance needs.

Which question is the court most likely considering?

- A) Whether the funding classification is reasonably related to a public need
- B) Whether counties may conduct foreign policy
- C) Whether snow removal must be funded only by private companies
- D) Whether courts should personally plow roads

GED-SOC17-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A workforce board compares two training options.

Program: Cybersecurity support, Commercial driving

Cost per trainee: \$5,500, \$3,200

Completion rate: 74%, 88%

Median starting wage: \$29/hour, \$23/hour

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Cybersecurity support has the higher starting wage, while commercial driving has the lower cost and higher completion rate.
- B) Commercial driving has the higher starting wage and higher cost.
- C) Both programs have the same completion rate.
- D) Cybersecurity support has the lower cost and higher completion rate.

GED-SOC17-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

During the late twentieth century, the growth of Native-owned media, including newspapers and radio stations, supported [D1] and helped communities share [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) tribal self-representation | colonial tax collection | Civil War battlefield command

D2) local news, language, and cultural information | overseas trade tariffs | plantation crop reports

GED-SOC17-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city issues a \$40 million bond for sewer upgrades. Over the life of the bond, the city expects to pay \$40 million in principal and \$14 million in interest.

What is the total expected repayment?

- A) \$14 million
- B) \$40 million
- C) \$54 million
- D) \$94 million

GED-SOC17-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires counties to provide secure document storage for court records. Counties may build their own facilities, join a regional storage center, or contract with another county, as long as the records remain accessible to courts and protected from damage.

Which statement best describes this state-local relationship?

- A) The state requires a function while allowing counties several ways to meet it.
- B) Counties may destroy court records if storage is expensive.
- C) Regional storage centers replace all state courts.
- D) Court records are unrelated to local government responsibilities.

GED-SOC17-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A canal improvement reduces a shipping route from 1,150 miles to 940 miles. How many miles shorter is the improved route?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC17-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the late twentieth century, many Vietnamese American communities developed business districts, newspapers, language schools, religious organizations, and veterans' associations. These institutions helped refugees and their children build economic networks and preserve cultural memory.

Which broader historical pattern is shown by the source?

- A) Refugee communities built institutions that supported economic life and cultural continuity.
- B) Vietnamese American communities avoided creating local businesses.
- C) Language schools prevented cultural memory from being preserved.
- D) Refugee experiences had no connection to community development.

GED-SOC17-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

A) Debt affordability limit

B) Revenue forecast

C) Need-based grant formula

D) Statutory authority

Targets:

T1) An official estimate used to guide budget planning

T2) A legal limit designed to keep borrowing manageable

T3) Power given to an agency or local government by law

GED-SOC17-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A furniture maker buys wood from forests in two countries and metal hardware from a third country. A new shipping delay affects the hardware supplier, so finished furniture cannot be assembled even though wood is available.

Which economic idea is most clearly shown?

A) A supply chain can be disrupted when one required input is delayed.

B) Production is unaffected by missing parts.

C) Wood availability always guarantees final assembly.

D) International suppliers cannot affect domestic manufacturing.

GED-SOC17-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state constitution dedicates revenue from a fee on heavy trucks to bridge inspection, pavement repair, and freight-route safety projects. The revenue may not be transferred to unrelated programs unless the constitutional rule is changed.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this rule?

A) Connecting a transportation-related fee to transportation-related public uses

B) Allowing truck fees to be spent on private gifts

C) Preventing the state from repairing bridges

D) Giving courts authority to set truck routes

GED-SOC17-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A court reviews a city fee on large concerts held in public parks. The city says the fee covers police, sanitation, and park cleanup costs. Event organizers argue that the fee is too high and should match the actual services required.

Which conclusion is best supported by the dispute?

- A) Local event fees may need a reasonable connection to public service costs.
- B) Cities may charge unlimited fees unrelated to public services.
- C) Public parks cannot be regulated during large events.
- D) Courts cannot review local fee systems.

GED-SOC17-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows participation in local environmental volunteer programs.

Year: 1990, 2010, 2030

Tree-planting volunteers: 8,000, 21,000, 36,000

River-cleanup volunteers: 12,000, 19,000, 27,000

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Tree-planting participation grew more than river-cleanup participation.
- B) River-cleanup participation decreased after 1990.
- C) Tree-planting participation was highest in 1990.
- D) Both programs had the same participation in 2030.

GED-SOC17-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state resilience fund starts with \$150 million. It awards \$46 million for wildfire prevention, \$38 million for flood protection, and \$24 million for emergency communications.

How much money remains in the fund?

- A) \$42 million
- B) \$48 million
- C) \$108 million
- D) \$150 million

GED-SOC17-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

Several towns form a shared building-inspection service. Each town keeps its own zoning laws, but the shared service hires certified inspectors and schedules inspections across town lines. Costs are divided according to the number of inspections requested by each town.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this arrangement?

- A) Sharing administrative capacity while preserving local policy choices
- B) Allowing one town to control the zoning laws of all other towns
- C) Replacing certified inspectors with private judges
- D) Preventing towns from cooperating on public services

GED-SOC17-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state compares applications for courthouse technology grants.

County: Harbor, Valley, Ridge

Annual case filings: 18,000, 9,500, 4,800

Current online filing rate: 30%, 12%, 5%

Local matching funds: \$2.1 million, \$0.8 million, \$0.4 million

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Harbor County has the most annual case filings.
- B) Ridge County has the lowest current online filing rate.
- C) Valley County has more local matching funds than Harbor County.
- D) Ridge County has the highest online filing rate.
- E) Harbor County has fewer case filings than Valley County.

GED-SOC17-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A described map shows an inland city connected to coastal export terminals by highway, rail, and a pipeline. The city has refineries, packaging plants, and logistics warehouses. Smaller towns along the routes provide repair shops, fuel stations, and worker housing.

Which conclusion is best supported by the described map?

- A) Transportation corridors can create economic activity beyond the main city and port.
- B) Inland cities cannot participate in export networks.
- C) Pipelines prevent logistics businesses from developing.
- D) Highways and rail lines are unrelated to settlement patterns.

GED-SOC17-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A regional water authority compares three conservation projects.

Project: Leak repair, Smart meters, Irrigation rebates

Cost: \$9 million, \$12 million, \$6 million

Estimated water saved per year: 1.8 billion gallons, 2.4 billion gallons, 0.9 billion gallons

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Smart meters cost the most and are estimated to save the most water.
- B) Irrigation rebates cost the most and save the most water.
- C) Leak repair and smart meters have the same cost.
- D) Irrigation rebates save more water than smart meters.

GED-SOC17-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires that penalties collected from companies that violate workplace safety rules be used for worker-safety training, inspection technology, or emergency medical response. Lawmakers may not transfer the money to unrelated programs unless the constitutional rule is changed.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Penalty revenue can be dedicated to a related public purpose.
- B) Workplace safety penalties must be used only for private gifts.
- C) Inspection technology cannot be funded by public money.
- D) Constitutional rules cannot restrict how penalty money is spent.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC17-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Encouraging planned maintenance through regular budget decisions — Explanation: The rule encourages steady funding for repairs instead of costly emergency borrowing later.

GED-SOC17-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Proposal B costs more per household but is expected to reduce landfill use more. — Explanation: Proposal B has a higher monthly fee, \$22, but a higher estimated landfill reduction, 18%.

GED-SOC17-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The restriction of voting rights after Reconstruction — Explanation: Poll taxes, literacy tests, and related rules reduced Black political participation after Reconstruction.

GED-SOC17-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Coastal conditions and resources support different economic activities. — Explanation: Cold waters, beaches, and mangroves support fishing, tourism, and shrimp farming.

GED-SOC17-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Funding formulas can balance physical condition with public service demand. | Different communities may define public need in different ways. — Explanation: The formula weighs building condition, security, disability access, and case volume.

GED-SOC17-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether drone delivery rules should be nationally uniform or allow local safety limits — Explanation: Source A favors national rules, while Source B argues for local limits near sensitive places.

GED-SOC17-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Workers and employers debated the role of unions in industrial life. — Explanation: Workers supported collective bargaining, while business leaders warned about costs and disruptions.

GED-SOC17-008 — Correct: D1=statutory authority; D2=unauthorized — Correct Answer: D1=statutory authority; D2=unauthorized — Explanation: Agencies are limited by powers granted in law, and action beyond those powers can be ruled unauthorized.

GED-SOC17-009 — Correct: 450 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 450 — Explanation: $\$7,500 \times 0.06 \times 1 = \450 in simple interest.

GED-SOC17-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Energy and transportation costs can influence agricultural business decisions. — Explanation: Higher fuel costs affect heating, delivery routes, and market choices.

GED-SOC17-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The state sets a required standard while cities choose an approved method for carrying it out. — Explanation: State law sets testing requirements, while cities choose certified laboratories.

GED-SOC17-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Hospital worker union membership increased while steelworker membership rose and then declined. — Explanation: Hospital membership rose steadily, while steelworkers rose from 1940 to 1960 and fell by 1980.

GED-SOC17-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: It creates a shared estimate to guide budget decisions. — Explanation: The revenue estimate gives lawmakers an official forecast for budgeting.

GED-SOC17-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Trade rules can pursue social goals while increasing costs for some businesses. — Explanation: Labor and safety certification may support ethical production but raise importer costs.

GED-SOC17-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public benefits should be distributed through transparent and neutral criteria. — Explanation: Published standards reduce favoritism in awarding public scholarships.

GED-SOC17-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Community institutions helped migrants address local social and economic problems. | Cultural and language resources were part of urban community-building. — Explanation: Neighborhood groups, newspapers, cultural centers, and legal-aid groups addressed housing, language, school, and work issues.

GED-SOC17-017 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The Coastal region uses a larger share of energy than its share of population. — Explanation: The Coastal region has 45% of the population but uses 55% of the energy.

GED-SOC17-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether the funding classification is reasonably related to a public need — Explanation: The court is considering whether extra snow-removal aid is reasonably tied to actual road costs.

GED-SOC17-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Cybersecurity support has the higher starting wage, while commercial driving has the lower cost and higher completion rate. — Explanation: Cybersecurity has the higher wage at \$29/hour; commercial driving costs less and has an 88% completion rate.

GED-SOC17-020 — Correct: D1=tribal self-representation; D2=local news, language, and cultural information — Correct Answer: D1=tribal self-representation; D2=local news, language, and cultural information — Explanation: Native-owned media supported representation, language, culture, and local news.

GED-SOC17-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: \$54 million — Explanation: \$40 million in principal plus \$14 million in interest equals \$54 million.

GED-SOC17-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The state requires a function while allowing counties several ways to meet it. — Explanation: Counties must provide secure storage but may build, join a regional center, or contract.

GED-SOC17-023 — Correct: 210 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 210 — Explanation: 1,150 miles minus 940 miles equals 210 miles.

GED-SOC17-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Refugee communities built institutions that supported economic life and cultural continuity. — Explanation: Business districts, newspapers, schools, religious groups, and associations supported community life.

GED-SOC17-025 — Correct: T1=B; T2=A; T3=D — Correct Answer: T1=Revenue forecast; T2=Debt affordability limit; T3=Statutory authority — Explanation: A revenue forecast guides budget planning, a debt affordability limit manages borrowing, and statutory authority is power granted by law.

GED-SOC17-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: A supply chain can be disrupted when one required input is delayed. — Explanation: Missing hardware prevents assembly even though other inputs are available.

GED-SOC17-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Connecting a transportation-related fee to transportation-related public uses — Explanation: Heavy truck fee revenue is dedicated to bridges, pavement, and freight-route safety.

GED-SOC17-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Local event fees may need a reasonable connection to public service costs. — Explanation: The fee is disputed based on whether it matches police, sanitation, and cleanup costs.

GED-SOC17-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Tree-planting participation grew more than river-cleanup participation. — Explanation: Tree-planting grew by 28,000, while river-cleanup grew by 15,000.

GED-SOC17-030 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: \$42 million — Explanation: Awards total \$108 million; \$150 million minus \$108 million leaves \$42 million.

GED-SOC17-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Sharing administrative capacity while preserving local policy choices — Explanation: Towns share inspectors and scheduling but keep their own zoning laws.

GED-SOC17-032 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Harbor County has the most annual case filings. | Ridge County has the lowest current online filing rate. — Explanation: Harbor has 18,000 filings, and Ridge has the lowest online filing rate at 5%.

GED-SOC17-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Transportation corridors can create economic activity beyond the main city and port. — Explanation: Routes support repair shops, fuel stations, housing, and logistics activity along the corridor.

GED-SOC17-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Smart meters cost the most and are estimated to save the most water. — Explanation: Smart meters cost \$12 million and save 2.4 billion gallons, both the highest values listed.

GED-SOC17-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Penalty revenue can be dedicated to a related public purpose. — Explanation: Workplace safety penalties are dedicated to safety training, inspection technology, or emergency medical response.